

June 10, 2026

To: INFORMS Prize for the Teaching of OR/MS Practice

Dear Members of the INFORMS Prize Committee:

I write to provide my full support of Dr. Mohammad Dehghani's nomination for the *INFORMS Prize for the Teaching of OR/MS Practice*. As Director of the Industrial Engineering and Operations Research programs at Northeastern University for more than twenty years, I supervised Dr. Dehghani from the time he joined our faculty in 2015. Even after my retirement two years ago, I have remained in close contact with him, meeting regularly to discuss his research and educational activities. Over the years, I have had the opportunity to observe firsthand his exceptional contributions as a teacher, curriculum innovator, and educational leader.

Dr. Dehghani embodies the qualities that this award seeks to recognize. He has consistently helped students develop not only strong analytical and technical skills, but also the practical judgment, communication abilities, and problem-solving mindset required to become effective OR/MS practitioners. His teaching philosophy emphasizes the application of quantitative methods to real-world challenges, ensuring that students understand both the technical and organizational dimensions of OR/MS work.

An outstanding instructor, Dr. Dehghani is enthusiastic, organized, conscientious, and exceptionally well prepared. He has demonstrated remarkable versatility in teaching a wide range of courses and has continuously expanded our curriculum to address emerging technologies and industry needs. Early in his career at Northeastern, he developed courses such as OR6500 Metaheuristics and Applications and IE7295 Applied Reinforcement Learning, which equipped students with advanced analytical tools while maintaining a strong focus on practical implementation. More recently, he developed IE5374 Applied Generative AI, a highly innovative course designed around real industry engagement. Through hands-on projects and industry collaboration, students gain experience directly relevant to co-ops and professional careers. The fact that students recently presented their capstone projects at Google speaks to the course's strong applied orientation and its success in preparing students for practice.

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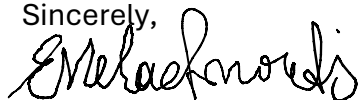
Dr. Dehghani's impact extends beyond individual courses. As Director of the Galante Engineering Business Program, he transformed the program by opening it to students from a broad range of engineering disciplines and introducing new initiatives that strengthen professional, leadership, and interpersonal skills. These enhancements have significantly increased the program's value and better prepared students for the multidisciplinary environments in which OR/MS professionals operate.

He has also been an exemplary colleague and mentor within the department. He has generously supported new faculty members, shared teaching materials and best practices, and contributed to a collaborative academic culture. In addition, his involvement with the INFORMS student chapter, including helping bring industry speakers to campus, has provided students with valuable exposure to practicing professionals and the realities of OR/MS work.

What most distinguishes Dr. Dehghani is his commitment to connecting theory with practice. Throughout his career, he has created learning experiences that enable students to apply sophisticated analytical methods to meaningful real-world problems while developing the broader professional skills necessary for success. His contributions have had a lasting impact on both our students and our educational programs.

I give Dr. Mohammad Dehghani my highest recommendation for the *INFORMS Prize for the Teaching of OR/MS Practice*. He is an exceptional educator whose work exemplifies the mission and spirit of this award.

Sincerely,



Emanuel Melachrinoudis, Ph.D.

Former Director, Industrial Engineering and Operations Research Programs

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